

Ellan Vannin Wealth Management

Strategic Sports Infrastructure Investment Memorandum

The Old Trafford Cricket Renaissance Project

A 21st Century Cricket, Entertainment and Urban Regeneration Campus

Executive Summary

Ellan Vannin Wealth Management proposes a long-term redevelopment strategy for:

Emirates Old Trafford Cricket Ground

transforming it from a traditional cricket venue into a **365-day international sporting, commercial and cultural destination**.

The investment thesis:

Cricket grounds should no longer be designed only for match days. They should become mixed-use economic assets generating revenue every day of the year.

The proposed redevelopment would create:

- a **45,000-seat international cricket stadium**
- premium hospitality facilities
- a world-class media centre
- a redesigned members' pavilion
- WFH/workspace facilities overlooking the pitch
- restaurants and coffee houses integrated into the stadium
- concert capability
- conference facilities
- year-round visitor economy

The project would reposition Old Trafford as:

"The Wembley of Northern Cricket."

Investment Philosophy

Traditional cricket economics face a structural problem:

- county cricket has loyal supporters
- international cricket attracts large crowds
- but ordinary county fixtures often struggle for attendance

The solution is not simply cheaper tickets.

The solution is to make the cricket ground a place people want to visit even without a major match.

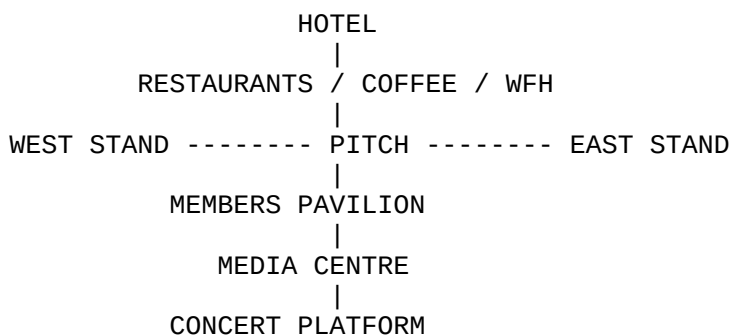
A modern stadium should operate as:

- workplace
 - entertainment venue
 - restaurant destination
 - conference centre
 - tourism attraction
 - sporting museum
 - community hub
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Strategic Vision

Old Trafford Cricket Campus

A fully integrated development:



Stadium Design

Capacity

Current modernised capacity:

~25,000+ seats

Proposed:

45,000 seats

Capacity Breakdown

Area	Seats
General admission	30,000
Members	5,000
Corporate hospitality	5,000
Premium boxes	3,000
Media/VIP	2,000

Why 45,000?

This allows Old Trafford to compete for:

- Ashes Tests
- World Cup matches
- T20 internationals
- ICC finals
- major concerts

Manchester is already a major international events city.

A larger stadium creates the ability to host global-scale events.

The Free County Cricket Membership Model

Proposal:

"Lancashire Cricket Pass"

Every member receives:

- free entry to County Championship matches
 - free entry to selected domestic games
 - discounted hospitality
 - voting rights
 - community benefits
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Economic Logic

County cricket attendance problem:

Low marginal cost seats + empty stadium.

Instead of selling every seat individually:

Increase:

- food spending
- retail spending
- memberships
- hospitality
- corporate usage

A full stadium atmosphere increases the value of the entire asset.

Example Economics

Assume:

20,000 members

Membership:

£150/year

Revenue:

£3 million annually

Benefits:

- predictable cash flow
 - stronger supporter base
 - higher food and beverage spending
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Coffee, Work and Cricket Concept

The Pavilion Workspace

Create:

- glass-fronted coffee shops
- meeting rooms
- co-working areas
- business lounges

overlooking the pitch.

Concept:

"Work from Old Trafford."

A professional could:

08:30

Arrive

↓

09:00–16:00

Work overlooking the cricket pitch

↓

17:00

Watch evening cricket

↓

Dinner afterwards

Revenue:

Coffee

Food

Meeting rooms

Corporate subscriptions

Events

Stadium Hospitality

Modern sports economics increasingly depend on premium customers.

Create:

Old Trafford Business Club

Facilities:

- 100+ executive boxes
- private dining
- networking spaces
- match-day lounges

- corporate memberships
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Example:

3,000 premium seats

Average spend:

£250/event

20 major events

=

£15 million annual premium revenue potential

Media Centre

Create Britain's leading cricket broadcast facility.

Includes:

- TV studios
- podcast studios
- analytics centre
- commentary boxes
- esports/cricket gaming facilities

Potential tenants:

- Sky Sports
 - BBC Sport
 - ECB
 - cricket technology companies
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Concert Capability

The stadium becomes a Northern England concert venue.

Design:

Retractable temporary stage system.

Capacity:

45,000 cricket

55,000 concert configuration

Potential events:

- major music concerts
 - festivals
 - boxing
 - corporate events
-

Example:

10 concerts/year

Average attendance:

40,000

Economic impact:

400,000 visitors

Hotel Expansion

The current venue already incorporates an on-site hotel, with previous redevelopment plans including expansion of hotel and hospitality facilities.

Proposal:

Expand to:

400-room cricket hotel

Features:

- cricket tourism packages
 - corporate conferences
 - international team accommodation
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Financial Model

Estimated Investment

£350 million

Allocation:

Component	Cost
Stadium redevelopment	£180m
Hospitality	£60m
Media centre	£25m
Coffee/workspace	£20m
Hotel expansion	£50m
Technology	£15m

Annual Revenue Increase

Current Model

Primarily:

- tickets
 - hospitality
 - events
-

Future Model

Revenue Stream	Annual
Membership	£3m
County attendance	£5m
International cricket	£20m
Hospitality	£25m
Concerts	£15m
Food/coffee	£10m
Conferences	£8m
Hotel	£12m

Potential additional annual revenue:

£98 million

Investment Return

Assume:

£350m investment

Additional EBITDA:

£35m/year

Infrastructure-style return:

IRR:

8–12%

With successful concert and international event growth:

Potential:

12–15%

Regional Economic Impact

Manchester gains:

- tourism
 - hospitality jobs
 - international visitors
 - conferences
 - media employment
 - construction employment
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Estimated:

Construction jobs:

3,000+

Permanent jobs:

1,000+

Integration with Manchester Growth Strategy

The stadium connects with:

- Trafford regeneration
- Metrolink
- hotels
- Salford Quays
- Trafford Park

Old Trafford becomes part of a wider sports and entertainment district.

Governance Structure

Create:

Old Trafford Cricket Development Company

Ownership:

- Lancashire Cricket
 - EVWM Infrastructure Fund
 - pension investors
 - private capital
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Long-term asset ownership.

No short-term property sale.

Final Recommendation

Ellan Vannin Wealth Management recommends:

The Old Trafford Cricket Renaissance Project

A £350 million transformation of Old Trafford into a world-leading cricket, entertainment and business campus.

The core principle:

Cricket grounds should not be empty monuments waiting for match days. They should become productive urban assets that generate economic value every day of the year.

A redeveloped Old Trafford could become:

- England's northern cricket capital
- a global Test venue
- a business destination
- a concert arena
- a tourism attraction
- a permanent economic engine for Greater Manchester

The future of cricket infrastructure is not simply bigger stands.

It is:

turning sport into a 365-day economy.